1. Basic facts

Full name and other names

- **Full name:** Sukhdev Thapar (often called simply Sukhdev) | The Tribune (Mar 2026) | > "Sukhdev (full name: Sukhdev Thapar; born on May 15, 1907 in Ludhiana, Punjab)"
- **Revolutionary pseudonyms and aliases:** Used the aliases "Grameen", "Kisan" (peasant), "Gwar", "Swami", and "Dyal" in underground work and police records | The Tribune (Mar 2026) | > "Sukhdev's revolutionary circle had many pseudonyms -"Grameen", "Kisan", "Gwar", "Swami" and "Dyal"." and Wikipedia: Sukhdev Thapar | > "It describes him as Swami alias peasant, son of Ram Lal, Thapar Khatri caste."

Born (date, place) / Died (date, place, how)

- **Born:** 15 May 1907 in Naughara Mohalla in the old city of Ludhiana, Punjab | The Tribune (Feb 2026) | > "Sukhdev was born on May 15, 1907, in Naughara Mohalla, in the old city of Ludhiana."
- **Died:** 23 March 1931 (at 7:30 pm, aged 23) at Lahore Central Jail, Punjab (now in Pakistan), executed by hanging alongside Bhagat Singh and Shivaram Rajguru | Wikipedia: Sukhdev Thapar | > "Thapar, Bhagat Singh, and Shivaram Rajguru were all hanged on 23 March 1931, in Lahore Central Jail." and The Tribune (Mar 2026) | > "their executions were advanced by 11 hours and were carried out on March 23, 1931, at 7:30 pm"
- **Cremation place:** Cremated on the banks of the Sutlej River at Hussainiwala, near Firozpur in Punjab | The Tribune (Mar 2026) | > "That same night, they were transported to the banks of the Sutlej river at the Hussainiwala border, near Ferozepur."

Family, education, work

- **Parents:** Son of Ram Lal (Ramlal) Thapar, a grain market commission agent, and Ralli Devi, in a Punjabi Khatri family (sources disagree on when his father died; see Section 4) | Wikipedia: Sukhdev Thapar | > "Sukhdev Thapar was born in Naughara area of Old Ludhiana, Punjab, British Raj on 15 May 1907 to Ramlal Thapar and Ralli Devi."
- **Uncle, brother, and cousins who raised him:** Brought up in Lyallpur (now Faisalabad, Pakistan) by his uncle Lala Chint Ram (also written Lala Achint Ram Thapar) and older cousin Gauran Devi, alongside his younger brother Mathra Das (Mathura Das) | The Tribune (Feb 2026) | > "Sukhdev was raised by his Tayaji, Lala Chint Ram, alongside his cousins — Parkash Chand, Gauran Devi, Krishna, Jaidev, and Krishan Lal."
- **Schooling in Lyallpur:** Completed his matriculation in 1922 in Lyallpur (sources name either Sanatan Dharma [SD] High School or Arya High School; see Section 4) | The Tribune (Feb 2026) | > "In 1922, Sukhdev passed matriculation from SD High School, Lyallpur, and enrolled at National College, Lahore, against his guardian's wishes."
- **College in Lahore:** Studied at National College, Lahore (founded by Lala Lajpat Rai for students boycotting British-run schools), where he met Bhagat Singh, Yashpal, and Bhagwati Charan Vohra | The Nation | > "he was an old student of National College of Lahore which was established by Lala Lajpat Rai for those students who were boycotting the colonial education."
- **Work in the independence movement:** Worked full-time as the chief organiser and

Punjab secretary of the Hindustan Socialist Republican Association, arranging safe houses, clothes, food, books, and bomb-making workshops in Agra and Lahore | The Tribune (Feb 2026) | > "Housing, clothing, food, travel, books, bomb-making material — he arranged everything, often with no money in hand."

Groups and organisations they belonged to

- **Naujawan Bharat Sabha:** Youth organisation founded in Lahore in March 1926, in which Sukhdev was a leading organiser and speaker | The Tribune (Mar 2026) | > "The Naujwan Bharat Sabha was founded by Bhagat Singh in March 1926. Sukhdev was among its leading members."
- **Hindustan Republican Association (HRA) / Hindustan Socialist Republican Association (HSRA):** Member of the Central Committee and head (secretary) of the Punjab unit after the September 1928 Feroz Shah Kotla meeting in Delhi | The Tribune (Feb 2026) | > "Sukhdev recruited members between 1927 and 1928, served on the Central Committee, headed the Hindustan Socialist Republican Association in Punjab"

The 9 most important events in his life (in date order)

1. **Enrolling at National College, Lahore, and befriending Bhagat Singh (1921–1922):** After finishing school in Lyallpur, he joined National College in Lahore, where he forged a close friendship with Bhagat Singh, Yashpal, and Bhagwati Charan Vohra | The Tribune (Feb 2026) | > "enrolled at National College, Lahore, against his guardian's wishes. There he met Bhagat Singh, Yashpal, and Bhagwati Charan Vohra."
2. **Co-organising the Naujawan Bharat Sabha (March 1926):** Helped build the Naujawan Bharat Sabha in Lahore to recruit youth across Punjab | The Tribune (Mar 2026) | > "The Naujwan Bharat Sabha was founded by Bhagat Singh in March 1926. Sukhdev was among its leading members."
3. **Founding meeting of the HSRA at Feroz Shah Kotla, Delhi (8–9 September 1928):** Joined comrades at Feroz Shah Kotla to rename the party the Hindustan Socialist Republican Association and became head of its Punjab unit | The Tribune (Mar 2026) | > "A secret meeting was held on September 8-9, 1928, at the Feroz Shah Kotla grounds in Delhi... He was entrusted with the responsibility of secretary of the Punjab unit"
4. **Planning the shooting of J. P. Saunders in Lahore (17 December 1928):** Helped plan the shooting of Assistant Superintendent of Police John P. Saunders in Lahore to protest the death of Lala Lajpat Rai | Wikipedia: Hindustan Socialist Republican Association | > "Bhagat Singh vowed to take revenge, and joined other revolutionaries, Shivaram Rajguru, Jai Gopal, Sukhdev Thapar and Chandra Shekhar Azad, in a plot to kill Scott."
5. **Arranging Bhagat Singh and Rajguru's disguised escape from Lahore with Durga Devi (19–20 December 1928):** Brought a clean-shaven Bhagat Singh to Durgawati Devi ("Durga Bhabhi") on 19 December 1928 so she, Singh, and Rajguru could escape Lahore by train the next morning | Wikipedia: Durgawati Devi | > "Two days after killing John P. Saunders, on 19 December 1928, Sukhdev Thapar called on Devi for help, which she agreed to do."
6. **Urging that Bhagat Singh carry out the Delhi Assembly bombing (April 1929):** Persuaded the HSRA and Bhagat Singh that Singh should throw the bombs in the Central

Legislative Assembly on 8 April 1929 to use the courtroom to explain their cause | The Tribune (Feb 2026) | > "Bhagat Singh was not the first choice for the Assembly action. It was Sukhdev who insisted that he be sent."

7. **Arrest at the Kashmir Building bomb factory in Lahore (15 April 1929):** Arrested by police along with Kishori Lal and Jai Gopal when police raided the HSRA's bomb-making workshop in Room No. 69 of the Kashmir Building on McLeod Road, Lahore | Wikipedia: Hindustan Socialist Republican Association | > "On 15 April 1929, police raided the HSRA's bomb factory in Lahore and arrested Pandit Kishori Lal, Sukhdev and Jai Gopal."
8. **Tried as Accused No. 1 in the Lahore Conspiracy Case and prison hunger strike (1929–7 October 1930):** Charged as the primary accused in *Crown versus Sukhdev and Others*, joined the 1929 prison hunger strike, and was sentenced to death on 7 October 1930 | Wikipedia: Sukhdev Thapar | > "Sukhdev was the main suspect in the 1929 Lahore Conspiracy Case, which was officially titled "Crown versus Sukhdev and others."... lists Sukhdev as accused number one."
9. **Execution in Lahore Central Jail and secret cremation at Hussainiwala (23 March 1931):** Hanged at 7:30 pm on 23 March 1931 (11 hours ahead of schedule) alongside Bhagat Singh and Rajguru, after which British authorities secretly burned their bodies by the Sutlej River at Hussainiwala | The Tribune (Mar 2026) | > "their executions were advanced by 11 hours and were carried out on March 23, 1931, at 7:30 pm after the authorities broke through the rear wall of the Lahore jail."

2. Story angles (at least 10)

Angle 1: The Schoolboy Who Refused to Salute a Visiting British Officer

- **Title:** The Boy Who Kept His Hand Down
- **One-line hook:** When a British official visited his school in Lyallpur, young Sukhdev flatly refused to raise his hand in a salute.
- **Key facts:**
  - While studying at Shri Sanatan Dharma School in Lyallpur, Sukhdev refused to salute a visiting British officer | The Tribune (Mar 2026) | > "Sukhdev received his early education at Shri Sanatan Dharma School, Lyallpur and higher studies at National College, Lahore. As a student in school, he refused to salute the visiting officer."
  - He had been raised after his parents' deaths by his uncle Lala Achint Ram Thapar, a freedom fighter who spent 19 years in British prisons | The Tribune (Mar 2026) | > "His journey was notably shaped by Lala Achint Ram, a courageous freedom fighter who resisted British rule and endured 19 years of imprisonment"

Angle 2: Burning Off His Own Arm Tattoos with Nitric Acid

- **Title:** The Boy Who Erased His Own Name with Acid
- **One-line hook:** Worried that the tattoos of his name and the symbol "Om" on his arm could help British police identify his secret group, Sukhdev poured nitric acid on his skin to burn them off—and said he wanted to see how much pain he could take.
- **Key facts:**

- Sukhdev had tattoos of his name and the symbol "Om" on his arm | The Tribune (Feb 2026) | > "Once, fearing that the tattoos on his arm — his name and Om — could endanger the group, he applied nitric acid to burn them away, badly injuring himself."
- When comrades asked why he hurt himself so badly with nitric acid, he said he wanted to test how much pain he could endure | The Tribune (Feb 2026) | > "Asked why he had done something so reckless, he replied that he wanted to test the threshold of his capacity to bear pain."

Angle 3: Always Borrowing Clothes for "Friends" While Wearing Shabby Ones Himself

- **Title:** The Organiser Who Gave Away All His Clothes
- **One-line hook:** Sukhdev's older cousin Gauran Devi kept wondering why his "friends" went through so many shirts—because Sukhdev was secretly collecting clothes, food, and rent money for underground freedom fighters across Punjab while wearing worn-out clothes himself.
- **Key facts:**
  - According to his cousin Gauran Devi (FAMILY MEMORY by Gauran Devi, reported in *The Tribune*), Sukhdev was always out of money and constantly asking family members for clothes for his "friends" | The Tribune (Feb 2026) | > "His cousin Gauran Devi later recalled, with affection and bewilderment, that he was perpetually short of funds, never embarrassed to ask for help, and constantly collecting clothes for “friends”"
  - According to fellow revolutionary Shiv Verma (LATER MEMORY by comrade Shiv Verma), Sukhdev always made sure his comrades had clothes and food before taking anything for himself | The Tribune (Feb 2026) | > "Revolutionary Shiv Verma remembered that Sukhdev clothed others before himself. A fellow prisoner in Lahore Central Jail recalled his laughter, warmth, and delight in feeding and clothing comrades"

Angle 4: The Midnight Knock on Room 69 and the Friend Durga Bhabhi Could Not Recognise

- **Title:** "Meet My New Friend": The Disguise Test at Room 69
- **One-line hook:** Two nights after a police officer was shot in Lahore, Sukhdev knocked on Durga Bhabhi's door with a clean-shaven stranger in a Western suit—and laughed when even she could not tell that the stranger was her close friend Bhagat Singh.
- **Key facts:**
  - After the 17 December 1928 shooting of John P. Saunders in Lahore, Kuldip Nayar notes the group had not planned their escape until Sukhdev advised them to leave the city | The Nation | > "Finally, on the advice of Sukhdev Thapar, they decided to leave Lahore"
  - On the night of 19 December 1928, Sukhdev brought a clean-shaven Bhagat Singh dressed in Western clothes to Durgawati Devi ("Durga Bhabhi") and introduced him as a "new friend" | Wikipedia: Durgawati Devi | > "when Singh and Sukhdev came to her house on the night of 19 December 1928, Sukhdev introduced Singh as a new friend. Devi could not recognize Singh at all."
  - Sukhdev pointed out that if Durga Bhabhi could not recognise Bhagat Singh without his turban and beard, the British police looking for a bearded Sikh would not recognise him

on the train either | Wikipedia: Durgawati Devi | > "Sukhdev told Devi the truth and said that if Devi could not recognise Singh in his changed clean-shaved appearance despite knowing him well, surely the police would also not recognize him"

Angle 5: Why Sukhdev Sent His Best Friend to the Assembly Gallery

- **Title:** The Argument That Sent Bhagat Singh to Parliament
- **One-line hook:** The revolutionary committee first wanted to keep Bhagat Singh safe and send someone else to throw the smoke bombs in Delhi's parliament—until Sukhdev convinced everyone that only Bhagat Singh could turn the courtroom trial into a message the whole country would hear.
- **Key facts:**
  - The HSRA committee initially did not choose Bhagat Singh to throw the bombs in the Central Legislative Assembly | The Tribune (Feb 2026) | > "Bhagat Singh was not the first choice for the Assembly action. It was Sukhdev who insisted that he be sent."
  - Sukhdev argued that the real purpose of the bomb was not the explosion, but the courtroom speeches afterward, and that Bhagat Singh was best able to explain the HSRA's goals to the public | The Tribune (Feb 2026) | > "He understood, with exceptional clarity, that the bomb itself was not the climax; the courtroom would be... Sukhdev believed only Bhagat Singh was fully equipped."

Angle 6: Empty Bomb Shells and the Police Raid on Room No. 69, Kashmir Building

- **Title:** The Trail of Empty Shells to Room 69
- **One-line hook:** Just one week after the Delhi Assembly bombing, Lahore police spotted one of Sukhdev's helpers carrying empty iron shells that matched the Delhi bombs—and followed him straight to Sukhdev's secret workshop in Room 69 of the Kashmir Building.
- **Key facts:**
  - Sukhdev and his comrades operated a bomb-making workshop in Room No. 69 of the Kashmir Building on McLeod Road in Lahore, rented in the name of Durga Devi | The Nation | > "The room or apartment no 69 was located in the premises of Kashmir Building on McLeod Road Lahore."
  - Historian Bakhshish Singh Nijjar recounts that police spotted associate Pandit Kishori Lal carrying empty bomb shells of the same type used in the Delhi Assembly and followed him to the Kashmir Building | The Nation | > ""“Sukhdev set up a bomb factory in the Kashmir Building at Lahore. Pandit Kishori Lal, one of his associates, was once noticed by the police, carrying some empty shells”"
  - On 15 April 1929, police raided the Lahore workshop and arrested Sukhdev, Kishori Lal, and Jai Gopal | Wikipedia: Hindustan Socialist Republican Association | > "On 15 April 1929, police raided the HSRA's bomb factory in Lahore and arrested Pandit Kishori Lal, Sukhdev and Jai Gopal."

Angle 7: "Accused Number One"—Why the Trial Was Named *Crown vs. Sukhdev and Others*

- **Title:** Accused Number One: "The Brain of the Conspiracy"

- **One-line hook:** Even though Bhagat Singh became the most famous face of the trial, the British police listed 22-year-old Sukhdev at the very top of the charge sheet as "Accused Number One", and the judges called him "the brain of the conspiracy."
- **Key facts:**
  - When Senior Superintendent of Police Hamilton Harding (also spelled Hardy) filed the First Information Report (FIR) in April 1929 against 27 people, the official case was titled *Crown versus Sukhdev and Others* | Wikipedia: Sukhdev Thapar | > "Sukhdev was the main suspect in the 1929 Lahore Conspiracy Case, which was officially titled "Crown versus Sukhdev and others."... lists Sukhdev as accused number one."
  - Sukhdev was listed at number 1 on the police FIR, while Bhagat Singh was listed at number 12 and Rajguru at number 20 | The Tribune (Mar 2026) | > "Sukhdev was listed first in the FIR, with Bhagat Singh at the twelfth and Rajguru at the twentieth spots."
  - In the death sentence judgment on 7 October 1930, Justice G. C. Hilton's tribunal called Sukhdev "the brain of the conspiracy" and Bhagat Singh "his right arm" | The Tribune (Feb 2026) | > "The judgment stated without ambiguity that Sukhdev was “the brain of the conspiracy”, while Bhagat Singh was “his right arm”."

Angle 8: Sukhdev's Final Letter Printed in *The Tribune* Five Days After His Death

- **Title:** The Letter Published After the Gallows
- **One-line hook:** Five days after Sukhdev was hanged in Lahore Central Jail, *The Tribune* newspaper printed a letter he had written before his death explaining why he and his friends had given their lives to wake up the country.
- **Key facts:**
  - On 7 October 1930, the day the tribunal sentenced him to death, Sukhdev wrote a letter to his comrades explaining that their actions were meant to awaken public resistance | The Tribune (Mar 2026) | > "Our actions responded to the grievances of the public. We aimed to inspire revolutionary ideals, and such ideals sound more glorious from the mouth of someone who has been hanged"
  - On 28 March 1931—five days after his execution—*The Tribune* published Sukhdev's letter posthumously | The Tribune (Jan 2025) | > "As Sukhdev's letter, published posthumously in The Tribune on March 28, 1931, explained, their effort was to inspire the people to oppose the British more vigorously."

Angle 9: "I Will Go First" and the Broken Back Wall of Lahore Jail

- **Title:** Eleven Hours Early and the Broken Prison Wall
- **One-line hook:** Afraid of the huge crowds gathering outside Lahore Central Jail, British officials moved the execution forward by 11 hours, asked who would step up first—and after Sukhdev said "I will go first," knocked a hole through the back wall of the prison to sneak the bodies out at night.
- **Key facts:**
  - The execution was scheduled for 24 March 1931, but authorities moved it 11 hours earlier to 7:30 pm on 23 March 1931 | The Tribune (Mar 2026) | > "On October 7, 1930, the tribunal set the execution date for the three revolutionaries - Sukhdev, Bhagat Singh, and

Rajguru - for March 24, 1931. However, due to public outrage, their executions were advanced by 11 hours"

- According to journalist Kuldip Nayar's book *Without Fear: The Life and Trial of Bhagat Singh* (SECONDARY / BIOGRAPHICAL ACCOUNT by Kuldip Nayar), when the executioner asked who would go first, Sukhdev answered, *"I will go first"* | The Tribune (Mar 2026) | > "Kuldip Nayar, in his book "Without Fear: The Life and Trial of Bhagat Singh", recounts that when the executioner asked who would go first, Sukhdev replied, "I will go first.""
- Officials broke through the rear wall of Lahore Central Jail to remove the bodies at night and burn them with kerosene by the Sutlej River at Hussainiwala, where villagers pulled the remains from the river before dawn | The Tribune (Mar 2026) | > "after the authorities broke through the rear wall of the Lahore jail... Their partially burned remains were discarded into the Sutlej. However, before dawn, local villagers retrieved the bodies"

Angle 10: What Happened After—The Hidden Brick House in Naughara Mohalla

- **Title:** The Birthplace Hidden Behind Five Houses in Old Ludhiana
- **One-line hook:** For decades after India became free, the small brick house in Ludhiana where Sukhdev was born was hemmed in behind five other buildings in a narrow lane and nearly collapsed before a court case and a six-year campaign finally cleared a path to it.
- **Key facts:**
  - Sukhdev's three-storey brick birthplace stands in Naughara Mohalla ("Nine-House Lane"), built by Thapar families in the old city of Ludhiana | The Tribune (Feb 2026) | > "Sukhdev was born on May 15, 1907, in Naughara Mohalla, in the old city of Ludhiana. The mohalla derived its name from nine houses built in a cluster by Thapar families"
  - After *The Tribune* reported on the crumbling house in March 2007, advocate H. C. Arora filed a Public Interest Litigation in the Punjab and Haryana High Court, leading to full monument protection in November 2014 | The Tribune (Feb 2026) | > "In 2007, advocate HC Arora filed a PIL in the Punjab and Haryana High Court seeking protection of Sukhdev's ancestral house... Full protection came only in November 2014"
  - Because five buildings blocked the path from Chaura Bazaar to the house, the Ludhiana Municipal Corporation spent years acquiring the properties to open a direct walkway for visitors | The Indian Express (Jan 2026) | > "Located in congested Naughara Mohalla, the martyr's house currently stands hidden behind buildings with at least five properties blocking the direct path."

Which angle is the big "flagship" story, and why

Angle 7 (Accused Number One: "The Brain of the Conspiracy") combined with Angle 3 (The Organiser Who Gave Away All His Clothes) and Angle 4 ("Meet My New Friend": The Disguise Test at Room 69) is the best flagship story. Young readers almost always hear Sukhdev's name third in the phrase "Bhagat Singh, Rajguru, and Sukhdev," without knowing why he was executed or what he actually did. Showing that the British police listed him as "Accused Number One"—because he was the behind-the-scenes organiser who found every safe house, borrowed shirts from his family for his friends, and planned Bhagat Singh's train escape with Durga Bhabhi—turns a name on a statue into a real person a 10-year-old can picture.

3. People and places connected

People

- **Ram Lal (Ramlal) Thapar & Ralli Devi:** Sukhdev Thapar's father and mother in Ludhiana.
- **Lala Chint Ram (Lala Achint Ram Thapar):** Sukhdev's uncle in Lyallpur who raised him after his father's death and was himself imprisoned by the British for 19 years.
- **Gauran Devi:** Sukhdev's older cousin in Lyallpur who helped bring him up and remembered him constantly borrowing clothes for his revolutionary friends.
- **Mathra Das (Mathura Das) Thapar:** Sukhdev's younger brother, who later lived in Hapur.
- **N. N. Vohra:** Former Governor of Jammu and Kashmir and Chairman of The Tribune Trust, whose mother was Sukhdev's cousin and whose maternal grandfather was Lala Achint Ram Thapar.
- **Bhagat Singh:** Sukhdev's closest friend from National College, Lahore, whom the British tribunal called Sukhdev's "right arm" and who was hanged alongside him on 23 March 1931.
- **Shivaram Hari Rajguru:** Fellow HSRA revolutionary who took part in the December 1928 Saunders shooting and was hanged alongside Sukhdev and Bhagat Singh on 23 March 1931.
- **Chandra Shekhar Azad:** Commander-in-chief of the HSRA who worked with Sukhdev on the Central Committee and provided covering fire during the December 1928 Lahore action.
- **Bhagwati Charan Vohra:** Sukhdev's National College classmate and HSRA propaganda secretary, who wrote *The Philosophy of the Bomb* and died testing a rescue bomb by the Ravi River on 28 May 1930.
- **Durgawati Devi ("Durga Bhabhi"):** Revolutionary and wife of Bhagwati Charan Vohra, in whose name Room No. 69 of the Kashmir Building was rented and who helped Bhagat Singh and Rajguru escape Lahore on Sukhdev's request.
- **Lala Lajpat Rai:** Nationalist leader who founded National College, Lahore, and whose death on 17 November 1928 after a police lathi-charge led Sukhdev, Bhagat Singh, and Rajguru to plan the shooting of John P. Saunders.
- **John P. Saunders & James A. Scott:** British police officers in Lahore; Scott ordered the lathi-charge on Lala Lajpat Rai, and Saunders was shot outside Lahore police headquarters on 17 December 1928.
- **Pandit Kishori Lal & Jai Gopal:** HSRA associates arrested with Sukhdev at the Kashmir Building bomb factory on 15 April 1929 after police trailed Kishori Lal carrying empty bomb shells; Jai Gopal later became a prosecution witness (approver).
- **Shiv Verma & Yashpal:** Fellow HSRA members and friends of Sukhdev who later wrote accounts of his study of socialism and his habit of clothing comrades before himself.
- **Hamilton Harding (Hardy) & Justice G. C. Hilton:** The Lahore Senior Superintendent of Police who filed the April 1929 FIR listing Sukhdev first, and the tribunal judge who called Sukhdev "the brain of the conspiracy" and sentenced him to death.
- **Dr. B. R. Ambedkar:** Jurist and leader who wrote the editorial *"Three Victims"* in his newspaper *Janata* condemning the British government for hanging Bhagat Singh,

Sukhdev, and Rajguru to appease Conservative opinion in Britain.

Groups and Events

- **Naujawan Bharat Sabha:** Youth movement founded in Lahore in March 1926 by Bhagat Singh, Sukhdev, and comrades.
- **Hindustan Socialist Republican Association (HSRA):** Socialist revolutionary organisation formed at Feroz Shah Kotla in Delhi on 8–9 September 1928, whose Punjab unit Sukhdev headed.
- **Lahore Conspiracy Case (*Crown versus Sukhdev and Others*, 1929–1930):** Special tribunal trial in Lahore in which Sukhdev was Accused No. 1 and sentenced to death on 7 October 1930.
- **Shaheed Diwas (Martyrs' Day, 23 March):** Annual commemoration in India marking the 23 March 1931 execution of Bhagat Singh, Sukhdev Thapar, and Shivaram Rajguru.

Places

- **Naughara Mohalla, Old Ludhiana, Punjab:** Cluster of nine Thapar family houses in Ludhiana where Sukhdev was born on 15 May 1907 and where his protected ancestral house stands today.
- **Lyallpur (now Faisalabad, Pakistan):** Canal colony city where Sukhdev's father and uncle ran a grain agency and where Sukhdev grew up and completed high school in 1922.
- **National College, Lahore:** College founded by Lala Lajpat Rai during the Non-Cooperation Movement where Sukhdev studied and met Bhagat Singh.
- **Feroz Shah Kotla, New Delhi:** Ruined fort grounds in Delhi where Sukhdev, Bhagat Singh, and comrades met on 8–9 September 1928 to form the HSRA.
- **Room No. 69, Kashmir Building, McLeod Road, Lahore:** Apartment rented in Durga Devi's name that served as an HSRA safe house and bomb-making workshop until police raided it and arrested Sukhdev on 15 April 1929.
- **Lahore Central Jail, Lahore (now in Pakistan):** Prison where Sukhdev was held during the Lahore Conspiracy Case trial, took part in the 1929 hunger strike, and was hanged at 7:30 pm on 23 March 1931.
- **Hussainiwala National Martyrs Memorial, near Firozpur, Punjab:** Bank of the Sutlej River near the India–Pakistan border where British authorities secretly burned the bodies of Sukhdev, Bhagat Singh, and Rajguru on the night of 23 March 1931.
- **Shaheed Sukhdev College of Business Studies (New Delhi) & Amar Shaheed Sukhdev Thapar Inter-State Bus Terminal (Ludhiana):** University of Delhi college (founded August 1987) and Ludhiana's main bus terminal named in his memory.

4. Disputes, legends and doubts

1. When did Sukhdev's father Ram Lal Thapar die? (Three months before Sukhdev's birth in 1907 vs. in 1910 before his younger brother's birth)

- **Version A (Died in 1910, three months before Sukhdev's younger brother Mathra Das was born):** Author Harish Jain in *The Tribune* (Feb 2026) states that Sukhdev's father Ram Lal died in 1910 (when Sukhdev was about three years old), and that it was

Sukhdev's younger brother Mathra Das who was born three months after their father's death | The Tribune (Feb 2026) | > "Tragedy struck early. Ram Lal died in 1910. Sukhdev's younger brother, Mathra Das, was born three months later."

- **Version B (Died three months before Sukhdev's own birth in 1907):** Wikipedia states that Sukhdev's father died three months before Sukhdev was born | Wikipedia: Sukhdev Thapar | > "His father died three months before his birth and his mother died when he was young."

2. Which high school did Sukhdev graduate from in Lyallpur? (Sanatan Dharma [SD] High School vs. Arya High School)

- **Version A (Sanatan Dharma [SD] High School, Lyallpur):** Both *The Tribune* (Feb 2026) and *The Tribune* (Mar 2026) state that Sukhdev studied at Shri Sanatan Dharma (SD) High School in Lyallpur, passing his matriculation in 1922 | The Tribune (Feb 2026) | > "In 1922, Sukhdev passed matriculation from SD High School, Lyallpur, and enrolled at National College, Lahore" and The Tribune (Mar 2026) | > "Sukhdev received his early education at Shri Sanatan Dharma School, Lyallpur"
- **Version B (Arya High School):** Wikipedia states that after his early education at Lyallpur, he attended Arya High School and passed his high school exam in 1922 | Wikipedia: Sukhdev Thapar | > "After completing his early education at Lyallpur, Sukhdev attended Arya High School. He passed his High School examination in 1922"

3. Was Lala Achint Ram (Chint Ram) Sukhdev's paternal cousin-uncle (*Tayaji*) or maternal uncle?

- **Version A (Paternal uncle / father's cousin, called *Tayaji*):** Harish Jain in *The Tribune* (Feb 2026) describes Lala Chint Ram as a cousin of Sukhdev's father Ram Lal, whom Sukhdev called *Tayaji* (father's elder brother/cousin) | The Tribune (Feb 2026) | > "Lala Chint Ram, a cousin of Sukhdev's father Ram Lal, established a business there... Sukhdev was raised by his Tayaji, Lala Chint Ram"
- **Version B (Maternal uncle):** Ramjilal in *The Tribune* (Mar 2026), quoting former Governor N. N. Vohra, describes Lala Achint Ram Thapar as Sukhdev's maternal uncle | The Tribune (Mar 2026) | > "After his parents' deaths, he was raised in Lyallpur (now in Pakistan) under the care of his maternal uncle and NN Vohra's maternal grandfather, Lala Achint Ram Thapar."

4. Who was initially chosen for the 8 April 1929 Delhi Assembly bombing, and what was Sukhdev's stance?

- **Version A (Sukhdev and Batukeshwar Dutt were first chosen to throw the bombs, before changing to Bhagat Singh and Dutt):** Wikipedia's article on Batukeshwar Dutt states the initial plan was for Dutt and Sukhdev to plant the bomb while Bhagat Singh went to the USSR | Wikipedia: Batukeshwar Dutt | > "Initially, it was decided that Dutt and Sukhdev Thapar would plant the bomb while Singh would travel to the USSR."
- **Version B (Bhagat Singh was not the first choice, and Sukhdev insisted that Bhagat Singh be sent):** Both *The Tribune* (Feb 2026) and *The Tribune* (Mar 2026) state that Sukhdev was absent when the initial decision was made, opposed sending others, and

insisted that Bhagat Singh must go because only Singh could articulate the HSRA's goals in court | The Tribune (Mar 2026) | > "Though Sukhdev was not present at the meeting where the decision was made to throw a bomb in the Assembly, he opposed the plan. He believed that Bhagat Singh would be better able to articulate the HSRA's objectives."

5. Confusion between Sukhdev Thapar and another HSRA member named "Sukhdev Raj"

- **Name mix-up in some blogs/articles:** In *The Nation* (March 2017), the writer refers to Sukhdev Thapar in one paragraph as "Sukhdev Raj" when describing his 1931 execution (confusing Sukhdev Thapar with Sukhdev Raj, a different HSRA revolutionary who survived until after independence) | The Nation | > "However, Sukhdev Raj was arrested and later hanged with Bhagat Singh and Rajguru in Lahore District Jail on 23 March 1931."

5. Pictures

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1. **Portrait of Sukhdev Thapar (c. 1929):** File:Martyr Sukhdev Thapar.jpg | Historical studio portrait of Sukhdev Thapar wearing a dark coat and white shirt | **Date:** Listed as "before 1960" (c. 1929 portrait) | **Licence as stated on page:** Public domain ("This work is in the public domain in India because its term of copyright has expired or it is ineligible for copyright") and structured data Creative Commons Attribution-ShareAlike 4.0 International.
2. **Composite Portrait of Bhagat Singh, Sukhdev Thapar, and Shivaram Rajguru (before 1931):** File:Bhagat Singh Sukh Dev Raj Guru.jpg | Side-by-side archival portraits of Bhagat Singh, Sukhdev Thapar (centre), and Shivaram Rajguru | **Date:** Before 1931 | **Licence as stated on page:** Public domain ("This photograph is currently in the public domain in India... created before 1958" and "in the public domain in the United States").
3. ***Daily Milap* Poster on the Lahore Conspiracy Case Death Sentence (1930):** File:Daily milap poster of the Lahore conspiracy case 1930.Death sentence of Bhagat Singh ,Sukhdev and Rajguru.jpg | Archival Urdu poster issued by *Daily Milap* on the 1930 Lahore Conspiracy Case announcing the death sentences of Bhagat Singh, Sukhdev, and Rajguru, with portraits of the accused | **Date:** 1930 (photographed/uploaded 2 June 2021) | **Licence as stated on page:** Creative Commons Attribution-Share Alike 4.0 International (CC BY-SA 4.0).
4. **Front Page of *The Tribune* Reporting the Execution of Bhagat Singh, Rajguru, and Sukhdev (25 March 1931):** File:Bhagat Singh's execution Lahore Tribune Front page.jpg | Front page of *The Tribune* (Lahore) dated 25 March 1931 with the headline *"BHAGAT SINGH, RAJGURU AND SUKHDEV EXECUTED"* and portraits of Sukhdev and Bhagat Singh | **Date:** 25 March 1931 | **Licence as stated on page:** Public domain ("Front page of the Lahore Tribune in 1931 - therefore copyright has expired and image is now in Public domain" in India and Pakistan).
5. **Clipping of *The Tribune* News Report on the 1931 Execution:** File:The Tribune news report of Sardar Bhagat Singh's execution,1931.jpg | Close-up scan of the 1931 *The*

Tribune newspaper report detailing the execution and secret cremation of Bhagat Singh, Rajguru, and Sukhdev | **Date:** 1931 (uploaded 2 June 2021) | **Licence as stated on page:** Creative Commons Attribution-Share Alike 4.0 International (CC BY-SA 4.0).

6. **National Martyrs Memorial at Hussainiwala:** File:National Martyrs Memorial Hussainiwala.jpg | Photograph of the National Martyrs Memorial at Hussainiwala, Firozpur, marking the spot where Sukhdev, Bhagat Singh, and Rajguru were cremated in 1931 | **Date:** 27 November 2007 | **Licence as stated on page:** Creative Commons Attribution 2.0 Generic (CC BY 2.0).
7. **Statues of Bhagat Singh, Rajguru, and Sukhdev at Hussainiwala:** File:Statues of Bhagat Singh, Rajguru and Sukhdev.jpg | Photograph of the three statues of Bhagat Singh, Shivaram Rajguru, and Sukhdev Thapar at the Hussainiwala memorial near the India–Pakistan border | **Date:** 10 November 2008 | **Licence as stated on page:** Creative Commons Attribution 2.0 Generic (CC BY 2.0, permitted under Indian freedom of panorama, Section 52 of the Indian Copyright Act 1957).

6. Sources used

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4. Shaheed Sukhdev Thapar Memorial Trust members begin hunger strike in Ludhiana to protest neglect of martyr — *The Tribune*.
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17. File:Bhagat Singh's execution Lahore Tribune Front page.jpg — Wikimedia Commons.
18. File:The Tribune news report of Sardar Bhagat Singh's execution,1931.jpg — Wikimedia Commons.
19. File:National Martyrs Memorial Hussainiwala.jpg — Wikimedia Commons.
20. File:Statues of Bhagat Singh, Rajguru and Sukhdev.jpg — Wikimedia Commons.